



Moot Court: Turning Theoretical Knowledge into Real-World Skills

By Angeline Acantilado

Moot court, is an ancient English conclave of “freemen of a shire,” has evolved into a skill development exercise for law students, where hypothetical cases are debated. In contemporary legal education, mooting has become an indispensable component of the curriculum, serving as a preparatory mechanism for legal training of aspiring members of the legal profession. The West Visayas State University, College of Law, dedicated to promoting legal training extends its profound support to the Vox Populi Moot and Debate Circle. The organization actively participates in moot court and debate competitions annually. Notably, in October of this year, Vox Populi successfully claimed the title of Champion for the University of Cebu and Konrad Adenauer Stiftung (UC-KAS) International Environmental Law Moot Court Competition in Cebu City against 26 participating teams.

The UC-KAS team was composed of law students Emalyn Punzalan from JD-2B, and Faith Montalban and Yan Germinanda from JD-4A. Montalban and Germinanda earned the award as third and first Best Oralists in the Preliminary Rounds, respectively. Mentored by Prosecutor Federic Lois Regencia, Faith Montalban shared her formula for success in mooting, despite challenging review subjects: thorough preparation, gratitude to teammates and Prosecutor Regencia, and deep reflection on the impact of each mooting journey.

